> militant outfits receive money from Afghanistan and that allied forces must take actions due to their presence in Afghanistan. He added that Pakistan was dragged into war against Terrorism, and as long as this war continues, the illegal economy will also continue to progress (*The Nation*, 2012).

Indian contribution in funding the TTP had been surreptitious but tangible. In August 2008, three arrested terrorists belonging to TTP's Qari Hussain, known as 'Ustad-e-Fedayeen' (mentor of suicide bombers) (*Dawn*, 2009), revealed that he received Rs 680 million from 'an enemy country' (India).[10] The then Punjab Law Minister Rana Sanaullah and Federal Interior Minister Rehman Malik had been persistently vocal about Indian involvement in funding and abetting terrorists in Pakistan. The most credible statement came from the most known TTP spokesperson Ehsanullah Ehsan, who, after his surrender in 2017, claimed that they (TTP) received huge funds from Indian quarters.

The National Crisis Management Cell (NCMC) of Ministry of Interior, Pakistan, headed by Rehman Malik, claimed in a report that India's Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) was funding Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan's (TTP) Punjabi chapter, Asmatullah Muavia, Ghulam Rabbani and Qari Kamran factions through Afghanistan's Riyast-i-Amoor-o-Amanat-i-Milliyah (RAAM) and National Directorate of Security (NDS) (*The Express Tribune*, 2012). There was no subsequent confirmation or denial by the Ministry of Interior about the veracity of this report. However, later incidents and developments confirmed this claim. Ehsanullah Ehsan, the former spokesperson of TTP, and key commander of TTP's breakaway faction, Jamaat-ul-Ahrar (JuA), who surrendered to the Pakistan Army in April 2017, divulged that India was providing financial and logistical support to the TTP (*The Express Tribune*, April 17, 2017).

The then Pakistan Army spokesperson Major General Athar Abbas, in an interview to a Chinese newspaper, said that there were several hostile intelligence agencies that were supporting and funding terrorist groups in Afghanistan and Pakistan. He said that 'The drug money, smuggling and other multiple sources of income are helping the terrorists to conduct terrorist activities not only in Pakistan but also in Afghanistan' (*The Nation*, 2012).